

Discord Build Bot

A slash-command bot that answers “what build should I run?” questions by matching a character name to a Google Sheet of build guides — no LLM or external API key involved.

TRIGGER	DATA SOURCE	MATCHING	STATUS
Discord webhook	Google Sheets	Substring + fuzzy	Active

What it does

A player types `/build [character]` in Discord. The workflow verifies the request really came from Discord, looks up that character's build guides in a shared Google Sheet, and replies with the matching links — tolerating typos in the character name along the way.

Why it's built this way

- Discord requires a response within 3 seconds, but a Google Sheets lookup can be slower than that — so the workflow immediately sends a “deferred” acknowledgement (type 5), then follows up with the real answer once the lookup finishes.
- Every incoming request is verified with Ed25519 (Discord's signing scheme) using Node's built-in crypto module, so no signature-verification package or API key is required.
- Character matching runs in two passes: an exact substring match first, then a Levenshtein-distance fuzzy match (~30% tolerance) per word, so “Lanclot” still resolves to “Lancelot.”
- Discord messages cap out at 2,000 characters, so long build-link lists are split into ~1,900-character chunks and sent as separate follow-up messages.

Workflow steps

1

Get Build

Webhook node. Receives every Discord Interaction POST (app verification pings and slash-command invocations alike).

2

Verify & Parse Interaction

Validates the Ed25519 signature against Discord's public key. Handles Discord's one-time endpoint verification ping (type 1) and parses slash-command payloads (type 2), pulling out the character option, application ID, and interaction token.

3**Respond to Discord**

Sends the required immediate HTTP response — type 1 for the verification ping, or type 5 (“deferred, reply coming”) for a real slash command.

4**Is Slash Command?**

Branches so only genuine slash-command invocations continue on to the lookup logic.

5**Get Build Data**

Pulls the full build list from the “Granblue Fantasy Relink Builds” Google Sheet.

6**Match Character (No API)**

Tries a direct substring match against the requested name; if none is found, falls back to per-word Levenshtein fuzzy matching to tolerate typos. Formats the matching build links into a reply.

7**Chunking links**

Splits the reply into Discord-safe (<1,900 character) chunks so long build lists don't hit Discord's message limit.

8**Send Follow-up Message**

POSTs each chunk to Discord's webhook follow-up endpoint using the application ID and interaction token, with automatic retry on failure.

Notes

The Discord application's public key is hard-coded in the verification step rather than pulled from n8n credentials — worth moving to an environment variable or credential if this is shared or version-controlled. If signature verification ever fails unexpectedly, the code comments point to logging the raw request shape, since the location of the raw body can vary between n8n versions.